

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 15

By Atchley

A RESOLUTION to recognize Dollywood on the occasion of the park's fortieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, Dolly Parton opened Dollywood in her native Sevier County on May 3, 1986; in the ensuing decades, the park has become one of the world's leading family destinations, ranked No. 1 among U.S. theme parks by TripAdvisor; and

WHEREAS, in honor of its fortieth anniversary, Dollywood has many special events and surprises planned for the 2025 season, with the season passholder preview day set for March 14, 2025, and a new fortieth anniversary show debuting Memorial Day weekend; and

WHEREAS, additionally, a new drone and fireworks show honoring the fortieth anniversary season will take place as part of Dollywood's Smoky Mountain Summer Celebration, and a new opening ceremony will occur at the beginning of each operating day during the 2025 season; and

WHEREAS, the Imagination Playhouse, which features plays based on books from Dolly's Imagination Library, becomes a permanent fixture during the 2025 season, offering its much-loved shows for younger guests from March through the end of September, and the theater will offer a rotation of playhouse favorites guests have enjoyed through the years; and

WHEREAS, also in celebration of the fortieth anniversary, *Heartsong: The Movie* will be remastered and relocated to Dreamsong Theater as part of The Dolly Parton Experience; the film will run in conjunction with *Heidi Parton's Kin & Friends*; and

WHEREAS, through much growth and many changes over the years, Dollywood has remained true to its mission: to create a welcoming environment where families can enjoy making memories together; and

WHEREAS, Dollywood has brought joy to park goers from the world over and pride to the Volunteer State for four decades, and it is our privilege to recognize this Tennessee treasure on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize Dollywood on the occasion of the park's fortieth anniversary, extending our gratitude to Dolly Parton and park employees, past and present, who have worked to make Dollywood the best theme park in the country.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.